

Monday, 8 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Rain 16° 13°	BIRMINGHAM Rain 17° 12°	MANCHESTER Light rain 16° 11°	GLASGOW Light rain 16° 10°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Thousands of men in England with prostate cancer will now be offered a new, advanced radiotherapy treatment on the NHS.

This innovative treatment can cut the number of radiotherapy sessions from twenty down to just five. It's hoped this will make a huge difference to patients' quality of life and ease pressure on the health service.

HEALTH · UK
- 2

A new report reveals that many households are struggling with soaring bill debt, but don't know that help is available.

The spending watchdog says most people are unaware of special tariffs for things like water and broadband. This means many could be missing out on vital support to manage their finances.

COST OF LIVING · UK
- 3

Charities are warning that thousands of 'hidden homeless' women are being missed from official figures across the UK.

A recent charity-led census found that two-thirds of the women they counted would not have been recorded using the government's current method. This highlights a significant gap in understanding the true scale of homelessness among women.

SOCIAL AFFAIRS · UK
- 4

Illegal mini-marts that break the law will now face closure for up to a year, following a change in regulations.

Previously, shops caught breaking the rules in England and Wales could only be shut down for a maximum of six months. This tougher stance aims to crack down on illicit trading and protect consumers.

LAW · UK
- 5

Police are warning that drug gangs are 'cuckooing' hundreds of homes every week, taking over properties to deal drugs.

This practice sees vulnerable people's homes taken over by criminals, turning them into bases for illegal activities. It's a growing problem that leaves many victims feeling like prisoners in their own homes.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Get ready rock fans! Donington Park is gearing up to host the UK's biggest festival of rock and metal music this weekend.**

Download Festival is back, promising a huge lineup and an unforgettable experience for thousands of music lovers. Expect a weekend packed with incredible bands, mosh pits, and plenty of festival spirit.

| ON AIR – Are you a rock or metal fan? What's the best festival you've ever been to?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK
- 2 Rumours are swirling as fans are trying to predict the exact date of Taylor Swift's wedding to Travis Kelce.**

Swifties worldwide are meticulously searching for clues and hints about the superstar's upcoming nuptials. It seems everyone is eager to celebrate with the happy couple, even if it's just from afar!

| ON AIR – Are you a fan of Taylor Swift? Do you think she'll have a secret wedding or a huge celebrity bash?

CELEBRITY · FUTURE
- 3 A new drama is set to explore what happens when your middle-aged best friend starts dating your daughter.**

The series centres on Alice, who discovers her best friend Steve is in a relationship with her 26-year-old daughter. It promises to be a compelling watch, delving into the complexities of friendship and family.

| ON AIR – What would you do if your best friend started dating your child? Would you be able to handle it?

TV · FUTURE
- 4 Chelsea forwards Cole Palmer and Joao Pedro have made a surprise appearance in a promotional film for Madonna's new album.**

The footballers feature in the Queen of Pop's latest video, adding an unexpected twist to her album promotion. It's certainly an unusual collaboration, blending the worlds of music and sport!

| ON AIR – What's the most unexpected celebrity cameo you've ever seen in a music video?

MUSIC · NOW
- 5 K-pop group Le Sserafim say accepting their flaws and embracing humour took them to a new level of success.**

The band has spoken about overcoming internal tensions and online trolls to achieve their current popularity. It's a great message about resilience and finding strength in vulnerability.

| ON AIR – Which artists do you admire for their honesty and openness about their struggles?

MUSIC · NOW

On the schedule

- 1 Serena Williams has made a triumphant return to professional tennis at Queen's, securing a first-round doubles victory.**

The 44-year-old American icon, playing alongside Canada's Victoria Mboko, rolled back the years with a winning performance. It's an incredible comeback after 1,375 days away from the sport.

ON AIR – How impressive is it to see an athlete like Serena Williams still competing at the top level after so long?

TENNIS · UK
- 2 England's Lionesses face up to two rounds of World Cup play-offs after missing out on automatic qualification.**

Despite beating Ukraine 3-0, automatic qualification for the 2027 Women's World Cup was out of their hands. It means a tougher road ahead, but the team will be determined to secure their spot.

ON AIR – Do you think England will make it through the play-offs and qualify for the Women's World Cup?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 3 England head coach Thomas Tuchel says Bukayo Saka's fitness is being managed with 'a little bit of care' ahead of the World Cup.**

Concerns are being raised about the key player's condition as the tournament approaches. Ensuring he's fit and ready will be crucial for England's World Cup hopes.

ON AIR – How important is Bukayo Saka to England's chances at the World Cup?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 Scotland face an arduous summer with away games against Argentina and South Africa, followed by Fiji at Murrayfield.**

These challenging fixtures are part of the inaugural Nations Championship. It's a daunting prospect for the team, testing their mettle against some of the world's best.

ON AIR – Which Scottish player do you think will shine brightest during these tough summer fixtures?

RUGBY · UK
- 5 There were wins for Lancashire Lightning, Essex and Northants Steelbacks in the latest round of the T20 Blast.**

The domestic T20 competition is heating up, with teams battling it out for crucial points. It was a good day for these three sides, securing important victories.

ON AIR – Are you following the T20 Blast this season? Which team are you backing to win?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that listening to certain types of music while gardening can help plants grow faster.**
Researchers played classical and ambient tunes to a variety of plants, noticing a measurable difference in their growth rate compared to those in silence. So, next time you're tending to your petunias, perhaps put on some Bach!
- 2 The trend of 'micro-adventures' is gaining momentum across the UK, encouraging people to explore their local areas.**
Instead of grand holidays, many are opting for short, accessible escapades like overnight hikes in nearby parks or wild swims in local rivers, proving adventure can be found closer to home.
- 3 British pet owners are increasingly creating bespoke 'adventure playgrounds' for their indoor cats.**
From wall-mounted climbing shelves to elaborate tunnels and scratching posts, these feline-friendly installations aim to provide stimulation and exercise for house cats. Talk about purr-fect play!
- 4 A new appreciation for the simple joy of 'letter writing' is blossoming amongst younger generations.**
Eschewing instant messages, many are rediscovering the charm of handwritten notes and sending them to friends and family. There's something special about receiving a physical letter, isn't there?
- 5 Researchers have found that looking at photos of cute animals can improve concentration and productivity.**
So, if you're feeling a bit sluggish at work, a quick glance at some adorable puppies or kittens might be just what you need to refocus. Who knew procrastination could be productive?
- 6 The delightful art of 'guerilla gardening' is transforming neglected urban spaces into colourful oases.**
Community groups and individuals are secretly planting flowers and vegetables in disused plots and roadside verges, bringing a splash of green to concrete jungles. It's a lovely way to brighten up the neighbourhood!
- 7 Many Brits are embracing the calming ritual of 'tea tasting', akin to wine appreciation but with a cuppa.**
From exploring different blends and origins to noting aroma and flavour profiles, enthusiasts are elevating their daily brew into a mindful and sensory experience. Fancy a proper brew?

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a specific 'lucky' item of clothing that we wear for important events. What's yours?

ANSWER: IT COULD BE ANYTHING FROM A COMFY PAIR OF SOCKS TO A FAVOURITE OLD JUMPER THAT JUST FEELS RIGHT!

Q A recent poll asked Brits what small, everyday sound instantly makes them feel optimistic. What came out on top?

ANSWER: THE SOUND OF BIRDS SINGING IN THE MORNING! IT'S SUCH A LOVELY, NATURAL ALARM CLOCK, ISN'T IT?

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those little 'traditions' that we carry on, perhaps from our childhood or from family.**

Whether it's a special way you celebrate birthdays, a particular dish you always make on a certain day, or even just a ritual you have on a Sunday morning. What's a beloved tradition you keep alive?

- **You know how sometimes you hear a phrase or a saying and it just perfectly sums up a situation or gives you a little lift?**

Perhaps it's something your nan always used to say, a common proverb, or even a line from a film that stuck with you. What's a favourite saying or phrase that you often find yourself using or thinking about?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There is a planet made mostly of diamonds, called 55 Cancri e, located about 40 light-years away from Earth.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts on the International Space Station can tell if it's raining on Earth by looking out the window and seeing the clouds gather over specific continents.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The inventor of the Pringle, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one of the iconic Pringle cans, and his wish was granted.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time: 1/100th of a second.
- It is illegal to sing in a public place in Florida while wearing a swimsuit.
- The world's oldest known living tree, 'Methuselah', is a Great Basin bristlecone pine over 4,800 years old.
- The dot over the letters 'i' and 'j' is called a tittle.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- Japan has a 'Rabbit Island' (Ōkunoshima) that is home to hundreds of wild rabbits.
- Some species of jellyfish are biologically immortal, meaning they can potentially live forever by reverting to an earlier life stage.

On this day

Day 159 of the year, 206 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Chlodulf of Metz; Christian feast day: Jacques Berthieu, S.J.; Christian feast day: Jadwiga (Hedwig) of Poland; Christian feast day: Mariam Theresia Chiramel. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Nancy Sinatra, American singer and actress
- 1977 — Kanye West, American rapper, producer, director, and fashion designer
- 1943 — Colin Baker, English actor
- 1942 — Doug Mountjoy, Welsh snooker player (died 2021)
- 1966 — Julianna Margulies, American actress
- 1951 — Tony Rice, American bluegrass musician (died 2020)
- 1981 — Sara Watkins, American fiddle, ukulele, and guitar player
- 1970 — Kelli Williams, American actress and director

THE DAY TODAY

- 2007 — Space Shuttle Atlantis is launched on STS-117 carrying two truss segments and solar arrays to the International Space Station.
- 1968 — James Earl Ray, the man who assassinated Martin Luther King Jr. is arrested at London Heathrow Airport.
- 1995 — Downed U.S. Air Force pilot Captain Scott O'Grady is rescued by U.S. Marines in Bosnia.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1953 — An F5 tornado hits Beecher, Michigan, United States, killing 116, injuring 844, and destroying 340 homes.
- 1972 — Vietnam War: Nine-year-old Phan Thị Kim Phúc is burned by napalm, an event captured in a photograph moments later while the young girl is seen running naked down a road, in what would become an iconic, Pulitzer Prize-winning photo.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1982 — Bluff Cove Air Attacks during the Falklands War: Fifty-six British servicemen are killed by an Argentine air attack on two landing ships, RFA Sir Galahad and RFA Sir Tristram.

- 1961 — Marriage of Prince Edward, Duke of Kent to Katharine Worsley at York Minster.
- 1995 — Downed U.S. Air Force pilot Captain Scott O'Grady is rescued by U.S. Marines in Bosnia.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 160 of the year, 205 days left in 2026. Today Anniversary of the Accession of King Abdullah II (Jordan); Autonomy Day (Åland); Christian feast day: Aidan of Lindisfarne (Evangelical Lutheran Church in America); Christian feast day: Blessed Anna Maria Taigi. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1915 — Les Paul, American guitarist and songwriter (died 2009)
- 1961 — Aaron Sorkin, American screenwriter, producer, and playwright
- 1912 — Ingolf Dahl, German-American pianist, composer, and conductor (died 1970)
- 1928 — Jackie Mason, American stand-up comedian (died 2021)
- 1926 — Calvin "Fuzz" Jones, American singer and bass player (died 2010)
- 1961 — Michael J. Fox, Canadian-American actor, producer, and author
- 1978 — Hayden Schlossberg, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1954 — Pete Byrne, English singer-songwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1928 — Charles Kingsford Smith completes the first trans-Pacific flight in a Fokker Trimotor monoplane, the Southern Cross.
- 1965 — Vietnam War: The Viet Cong commences combat with the Army of the Republic of Vietnam in the Battle of Đồng Xoài, one of the largest battles in the war.
- 2008 — Two bombs explode at a train station near Algiers, Algeria, killing at least 13 people.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1965 — Vietnam War: The Viet Cong commences combat with the Army of the Republic of Vietnam in the Battle of Đồng Xoài, one of the largest battles in the war.
- 1954 — Joseph N. Welch, special counsel for the United States Army, lashes out at Senator Joseph McCarthy during the Army-McCarthy hearings, giving McCarthy the famous rebuke, "You've done enough. Have you no sense of decency, sir, at long last? Have you left no sense of decency?"

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)